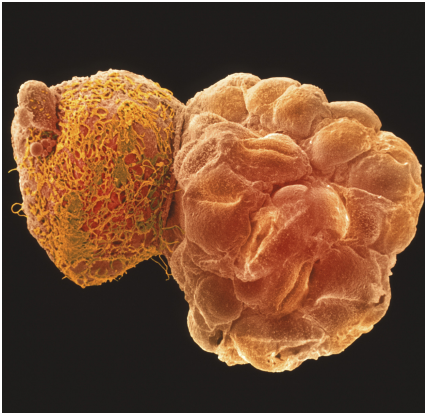




YOU ARE **2 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

261 days to go

WHAT'S HAPPENING INSIDE

This is an embryo at the blastocyst stage, five days after fertilization. It is seen hatching from the shell that originally surrounded the unfertilized egg. At this stage, the blastocyst has moved into the uterus and is preparing to implant.

“While playing the waiting game, you may want to consider how you’d feel if there are two fertilized embryos waiting to implant!”

Have you conceived, and might it be twins? Twins can be nonidentical or identical and each type of twins is conceived differently.

Nonidentical (dizygotic) twins are the result of two separate eggs being fertilized by separate sperm. They may also occur as a result of [IVF](#) if two embryos are placed in the uterus. Some estimate that the chances of having twins after fertility-enhancing treatment is as high as 1 in 38.

Identical (monozygotic) twins occur when a single egg is fertilized by a single sperm and divides into two embryos. This split can occur at any stage up to nine days after fertilization and its timing is critical to the way the placenta(s) and amniotic sac(s) are formed. If the [zygote](#) splits within the first three days, two separate placentas and amniotic sacs develop. If the split occurs at blastocyst stage, four to nine days after fertilization, the fetuses will share a placenta but have separate sacs; when the split occurs after day nine, the fetuses will share a placenta and a sac. The odds of having identical twins are about 3.5 in 1,000.

Having nonidentical (fraternal) twins depends a lot on family history. Your chances of having twins are simply higher if you have a close relative with twins, but twins never become inevitable.

Family history is most relevant when the nonidentical twins are on the mother's side as they rely on a woman releasing two eggs in any one cycle, which may be hereditary. However, a family history of twins on the male side can be important too. It may be that the man carries a gene that makes his daughter release more than one egg at a time at ovulation.